Faculty of Information Technology

FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1
FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1
FIT3188 Cyber Security Project Part 1

Mid-Semester Project Pitch - Individual and Group Sign-off, Group Presentation
v260817

Marking Criteria

Assessment Criteria	Weight
Presentation fluency (individual)	20
Content and contribution (individual)	20
Response to questions (individual)	5
Professional conduct (individual)	5
Pitch content (team)	30
Visual communication (team)	5
Presentation structure and flow (Team)	15

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Pitch marking breakdown

General Performance Standards

The following performance standards apply across all marking criteria and should be read together with the specific requirements described under each criteria.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	**Truly exceptional performance that clearly exceeds the requirements of the criteria.** All key requirements are demonstrated to a consistently outstanding standard, with substantial depth, quality and/or effectiveness beyond what is normally expected. **Meeting all requirements well, or simply having no obvious weaknesses, is not by itself sufficient for an HD.**
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	**Strong performance that fully meets the requirements of the criteria.** All key requirements are addressed effectively and to a high standard. The performance demonstrates the quality expected of a strong submission/presentation, but does not clearly demonstrate the exceptional standard required for an HD.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	**Good performance that meets the requirements of the criteria.** Key requirements are addressed appropriately, but there are noticeable opportunities for greater depth, quality, consistency or effectiveness.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	**Satisfactory performance that meets the minimum requirements of the criteria.** The essential requirements are demonstrated, but there are clear weaknesses, gaps or inconsistencies that limit the overall quality or effectiveness.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	**Performance does not adequately meet the minimum requirements of the criteria.** Important requirements are missing, substantially underdeveloped, inaccurate or ineffective.

Each criterion will be marked out of 10 marks and will be scaled to the main criteria marks in the final calculated marks

Presentation Fluency (Individual) (20 marks)

Assesses how effectively the student communicates their presentation material through clear and appropriately paced speech, effective use of voice and non-verbal communication, appropriate use of notes, and awareness of and engagement with the audience.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	Communicates with exceptional clarity and fluency throughout. Delivery is well-paced and highly effective, impactful, with purposeful use of voice and non-verbal communication, strong audience awareness, and minimal reliance on notes.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	Communicates clearly and fluently with a well-controlled pace and effective use of voice and non-verbal communication. Uses notes appropriately and maintains effective communication with the audience, with only minor weaknesses.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	Communicates clearly enough to be readily understood and maintains a generally appropriate pace. Delivery is mostly fluent, although there may be some reliance on notes, uneven pacing or reduced audience connection.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	Communicates understandably but delivery may be hesitant, uneven, overly reliant on notes or lacking consistent audience connection. Minimum expectations for spoken presentation are met.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	Communication is frequently difficult to follow or understand, or delivery relies substantially on reading presentation content. Problems with fluency, pace or delivery materially affect the audience's ability to follow the presentation.

Content and Contribution (Individual) (20 marks)

Assesses the quality and value of the student's individual contribution to the presentation. It also assesses the student's understanding and insight into the project, the relevance and substance of the material presented, how clearly it is explained and connected to the project, and the student's familiarity with their content.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	Demonstrates deep understanding and insight into the project through highly relevant and substantive content. Explanations are clear, convincing and strongly connected to the project and its context. The student demonstrates strong command of their material and uses it to demonstrate deep, project-specific understanding and insight. Their contribution is substantive, well-reasoned and effectively connected to the team's overall case.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	Demonstrates strong understanding of the project through relevant and informative content. Explanations are clear and appropriately connected to the project. The student demonstrates good familiarity with their material, and their contribution adds clear value to the audience's understanding of the project.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	Demonstrates sound understanding of the project and presents generally relevant and useful content. Explanations are mostly clear, although some areas may lack depth, detail or a strong connection to the wider project. The student demonstrates reasonable familiarity with their material.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	Demonstrates basic understanding of the project and provides a relevant contribution. Explanations communicate the main ideas but may be limited, unclear in places, or lack sufficient depth or connection to the wider project. Familiarity with the material may be inconsistent.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	Demonstrates limited or insufficient understanding of the project. Content may lack relevance, substance or meaningful contribution to the presentation. Explanations are unclear or poorly connected to the project, and/or limited familiarity with the material significantly affects the contribution.

Response to Questions (Individual) (5 marks)

Assesses the overall quality of the student's responses to questions directed to them. The teaching staff consider whether responses address the question, demonstrate accurate and sufficiently deep project understanding, justify decisions using relevant reasoning or evidence, and communicate limitations appropriately.

The teaching staff will aim to ask each team member at least one question. If a team member is present but is not asked a question due to time constraints, they will receive the average Q&A mark of the team members who were assessed. Although a question may be initially directed to a specific team member, other members may supplement the answer after the first member has responded.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	Provides consistently accurate, direct and well-reasoned responses demonstrating deep understanding beyond prepared presentation material. Justifies decisions using project-specific evidence, constraints or trade-offs; handles clarification or follow-up questions thoughtfully where asked; and identifies limitations or uncertainty appropriately. Demonstrates convincing performance across all core dimensions, with no material weakness. Polished or confident delivery alone is not sufficient.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	Provides clear, accurate and relevant responses demonstrating strong project understanding. Most decisions are supported by appropriate project-specific reasoning or evidence. Handles clarification appropriately, with only minor gaps in depth, detail, supporting evidence or treatment of more complex questions.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	Provides generally accurate and relevant responses demonstrating sound project understanding. Gives some useful explanation or justification, although complex issues, evidence, trade-offs or follow-up questions may be addressed only partly or at a relatively general level.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	Provides broadly relevant and mostly accurate responses demonstrating basic project understanding. Explanations or justifications are limited, general or partly developed, and reasonable prompting may be required. Important gaps may remain, but responses do not demonstrate a fundamental misunderstanding of the project.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	Frequently does not address the question, provides materially inaccurate, unclear or unsupported responses, or demonstrates insufficient understanding to explain key project decisions. Material misconceptions remain after reasonable clarification or prompting.

Professional Conduct (Individual) (5 marks)

Assesses the student's observable professional conduct throughout the presentation and Q&A. The teaching staff consider respectful interaction, appropriate participation, attentiveness, composure and contribution to a constructive presentation environment.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	Demonstrates mature professional judgement throughout and actively enhances the presentation environment. Interacts consistently and constructively with teammates and the audience, responds professionally to questions, correction or pressure, and exercises appropriate judgement without interrupting, dominating or undermining others. Demonstrates convincing performance across all core dimensions, with no material weakness. Merely avoiding inappropriate behaviour is not sufficient for HD.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	Demonstrates consistently strong professional conduct. Is respectful, attentive and constructive in interactions with teammates and the audience and contributes positively to the presentation environment. Any lapses are minor and have negligible effect on the presentation.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	Reliably meets the expected professional standard. Conduct is respectful and appropriate and generally supports rather than distracts from the presentation. Some aspects may not demonstrate the consistency, maturity or positive contribution expected at higher levels.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	Meets the minimum acceptable professional standard. Conduct and interactions are generally appropriate, but occasional lapses in attentiveness, composure or respectful participation detract modestly from the presentation environment.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	Demonstrates repeated or material lapses in professional conduct. Behaviour or interactions disrupt the presentation, materially detract from the presentation environment, or demonstrate disrespect toward teammates, teaching staff or audience members.

Pitch Content (Team) (30 marks)

Assesses how effectively the team collectively covers and connects the required pitch content, which includes the business case, project definition, planning and supporting evidence, to present a coherent and convincing case for the proposed project.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	Provides comprehensive, project-specific and convincing coverage of the required pitch content. Demonstrates exceptional understanding of the business problem/opportunity, objectives, users/stakeholders, assumptions and constraints; clearly defines appropriate requirements, SMART goals and a feasible scope; and presents well-reasoned option analysis, planning and supporting research/evidence. The content connects effectively to form a coherent and persuasive case for the proposed project, with no material gaps.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	Provides strong and well-developed coverage of the required pitch content. The business case, project definition, requirements, goals, scope, planning and supporting evidence are clear and relevant. The content forms a convincing and coherent project case, with only minor gaps in depth, justification, evidence or connection between elements.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	Provides sound coverage of the required pitch content and demonstrates an appropriate understanding of the proposed project. Most important elements are clearly addressed, although some areas may lack depth, justification, supporting evidence or clear connection to the overall project case.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	Provides basic but sufficient coverage of the required pitch content. The main project and business elements are identifiable, but some required areas may be underdeveloped, unclear, weakly justified or insufficiently supported. The overall case for the project is understandable but lacks depth or coherence.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	Provides insufficient coverage of the required pitch content. Important project or business elements are missing, substantially underdeveloped, inaccurate or poorly connected. The team does not establish a sufficiently clear, feasible or supported case for the proposed project.

Visual Communication (Team) (5 marks)

Assesses how effectively the visual aids communicate and support the pitch, including readability, organisation, consistency, visual hierarchy, and purposeful use of visual material.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	Visual aids are consistently polished, professional and highly effective throughout. Slides are exceptionally clear, readable and well organised, with strong visual hierarchy and an appropriate balance of text and meaningful visuals. Visual content is purposeful and significantly enhances the audience's understanding of the presentation.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	Visual aids are consistently professional, clear and well designed. Slides are easy to read and follow, with effective organisation and appropriate use of meaningful visuals. The visual aids clearly support the audience's understanding, with only minor opportunities for improvement.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	Visual aids are generally clear, consistent and appropriate for the presentation. Most slides are readable and suitably organised, with useful visual content, although some slides may be text-heavy, visually inconsistent, cluttered or less effective in communicating information.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	Visual aids are adequate and generally understandable, but show noticeable limitations in consistency, readability, organisation or use of meaningful visuals. Slides support the presentation at a basic level but may frequently rely on excessive text or ineffective visual design.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	Visual aids are unclear, inconsistent or insufficiently professional to effectively support the presentation. Significant problems with readability, organisation, excessive text, errors or ineffective/missing visual content interfere with the audience's ability to understand the material.

Presentation structure and flow (Team) (15 marks)

Assesses how effectively the team delivers the presentation as one coordinated whole, including its overall structure and organisation, opening and conclusion, transitions between speakers, time management, and coordination between all team members.

Grade	Description
High Distinction (HD) (8–10)	The presentation is exceptionally well structured, coordinated and cohesive throughout. It has a clear and highly impactful, purposeful opening, logical progression of content, seamless transitions between speakers, effective time management, and a strong conclusion that brings the pitch together. Team members work as a unified group and consistently support the overall flow without distracting from the current speaker.
Distinction (D) (7–7.9)	The presentation is well structured and coordinated. The opening, progression of content, speaker transitions, timing and conclusion are clear and effective. Team members work together smoothly and support the presentation flow, with only minor weaknesses that have little effect on the overall delivery.
Credit (C) (6–6.9)	The presentation is generally well structured and easy to follow. Organisation, transitions, timing and team coordination are mostly effective, although some parts may feel uneven, disconnected or less smoothly managed. The team generally supports the presentation without significant distraction.
Pass (P) (5–5.9)	The presentation demonstrates basic structure and coordination, but there are noticeable problems with organisation, transitions, pacing, timing, opening/conclusion or coordination between team members. The presentation remains understandable overall, but at times feels more like separate individual contributions than a coordinated team presentation.
Fail (N) (0–4.9)	The presentation demonstrates limited or ineffective structure and coordination. Significant problems with organisation, transitions, timing, opening/conclusion or team coordination disrupt the presentation and make it difficult to follow as a coherent team pitch.